CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 5: **Universal Franchise and India's Electoral System** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A policy which says only taxpayers may vote would contradict 1

(a) universal adult franchise **(b)** FPTP
(c) EVM use **(d)** NOTA

2. A voter in a remote area is too old to travel. Which facility helps? 1

(a) Sending a relative **(b)** Skipping vote
(c) Home voting **(d)** Proxy

3. Which is a long-term solution to criminal candidates in politics? 1

(a) Banning voting **(b)** Informed voters rejecting them
(c) Ignoring crime **(d)** Increasing money

4. How would a longer campaign period affect fairness? 1

(a) No effect **(b)** Could favour richer parties
(c) End bribery **(d)** Help all equally

5. A candidate offers cash for votes. Under the law this is 1

(a) campaign **(b)** bribery and punishable
(c) permitted **(d)** charity

6. A historian cites the Uttaramerur inscription. This is 1

(a) a modern law
(b) a map
(c) a film
(d) a primary source for local democracy in the 10th century

7. In which situation does a Presidential election involve MLAs? 1

(a) Only in Delhi **(b)** Always, through the Electoral College
(c) Only if tied **(d)** Never

8. Which statement correctly explains why reserved seats exist? 1

(a) To give historically excluded groups a voice
(b) To exclude others
(c) To raise taxes
(d) To reduce competition

9. **Assertion (A):** In the First-Past-the-Post system the winner is the candidate with the most votes. 1
Reason (R): A candidate can win without getting more than half of the votes cast.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Election Commission of India was set up in 1950. 1
Reason (R): The Election Commission is an independent body that organises elections.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What makes the Uttaramerur inscription historically important? 2

12. Why is a printed voter roll's accuracy crucial? 2

13. How can fake news harm elections? 2

14. How did T. N. Seshan strengthen the ECI? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Compare the Presidential and Vice-Presidential election. 3

16. Argue for and against compulsory voting. 3

17. Explain how media can both help and harm elections. 3

OR

Analyse the effect of money power on fairness. 3

18. Evaluate the role of reserved constituencies in a diverse democracy. 3

OR

Assess the role of youth in a democracy. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Before Independence only about 13 per cent of Indians could vote, since the right depended on property and education. In contrast, the Uttaramerur inscriptions of the 10th century describe a transparent method of choosing village representatives. Independent India gave every adult the vote in the first general elections of 1951-52. 5
(i) What share of Indians could vote before Independence?
(ii) Which inscriptions describe an early village election system?
(iii) In which years were the first general elections held?
(iv) How does universal adult franchise strengthen democracy?

20. Discuss the need for the Model Code of Conduct. Evaluate its enforcement through a hypothetical example. 5

OR

You are the District Election Officer. Plan a campaign to increase voting in your district. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks